PROBLEM 21 | Problems T2 defects.pdf | Crystal Defects & Solid Solutions

Proof of Dislocation Energy in FCC: [100] vs [110] Directions

Original statement · Problems T2 defects.pdf

> *7. For a metal with FCC structure, E_1 and E_2 are the energies necessary to generate dislocations in the directions $[100]$ and $[110]$, respectively. Demonstrate that $E_1/E_2 = 2$.* *(Solution: theory)*
>
> Solution: theory

PHASE 1: HYPOTHESIS & PARAMETERS

Lattice Model:

- Structure: Face-Centred Cubic (FCC), with lattice parameter a.
- Relation to the atomic radius: $a\sqrt{2} = 4R \implies a = 2\sqrt{2}R$.

Definition of Energies:

- E_1: Elastic energy per unit length to generate a dislocation with Burgers vector along the $[100]$ direction.
- E_2: Elastic energy per unit length to generate a dislocation with Burgers vector along the $[110]$ direction.

PHASE 2: FUNDAMENTAL PHYSICS & FORMULA SELECTION

Citing Frank's theory and the mechanics of dislocations [Session 4 Slides 29, 36]:

1. **Frank's Rule for the Elastic Energy of a Dislocation:**

The elastic strain energy stored in the elastic distortion field surrounding a dislocation is directly proportional to the **square of the magnitude of its Burgers vector**:

$$E \propto |\vec{b}|^2$$

2. **Determination of the Minimum Translation Vectors:**

For a dislocation to be kinematically stable in the crystal lattice, its Burgers vector must connect two equivalent lattice atomic positions:

- In the $[100]$ direction, the minimum translation joining two FCC lattice nodes (two adjacent vertices) is the full edge:

$$\vec{b}_1 = a[1\,0\,0]$$

- In the $[110]$ direction, owing to the presence of the face-centred atom, the shortest lattice translation goes from a vertex to the face centre:

$$\vec{b}_2 = \frac{a}{2}[1\,1\,0]$$
